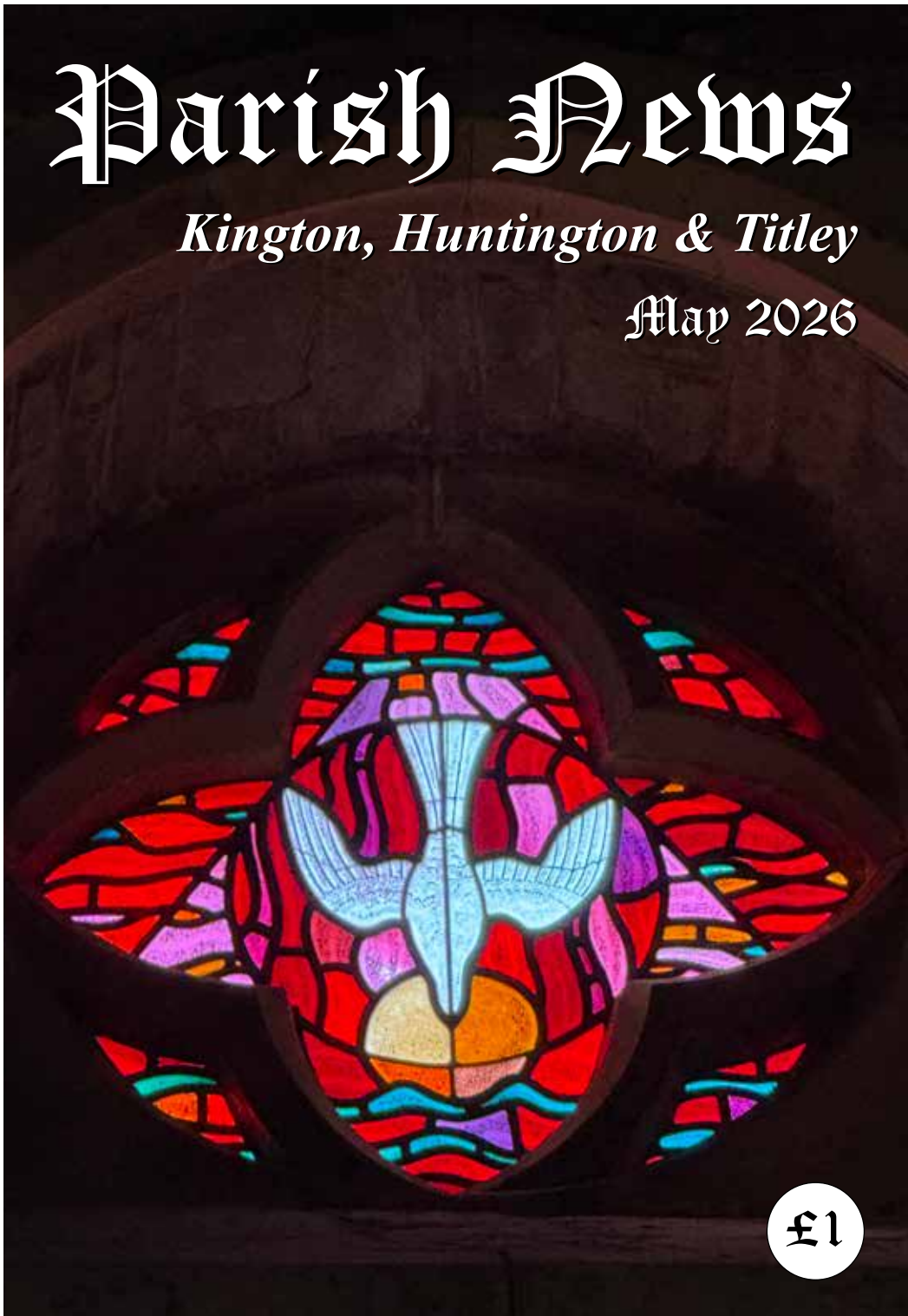


Parish News

Kington, Huntington & Titley

May 2026



£1

THE KINGTON PARISHES



**St Mary, Kington; St Thomas a Becket, Huntington
St Stephen, Old Radnor; St Mary, Kinnerton; St Peter, Titley**
www.kingtonparishes.org.uk

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St. Mary's, Kington PCC is a registered charity and its number is 1185453

Cover: Stained glass window, St Mary's Kington

Notes from the Curate

The Value of Companionship

Last Summer a friend and I decided to walk part of the Mortimer Trail from Ludlow to Croft. We set off with plenty of water and snacks, a digital and paper map, a route guide and first aid kit. On a couple of occasions we made a wrong turn, the first was when logging activity had obliterated the path and the second was at a T junction where the instructions were not clear. Thankfully, we realised the error of our way quite quickly and returned to the correct route. It was a lovely day with splendid views, and I was really glad of the company.

This experience reminded me of the importance of good friends and wise counsel. The prophet Jeremiah (18:15) hints at this when he writes “But my people have forgotten me, they burn offerings to a delusion; they have stumbled in their ways, in the ancient roads, and have gone into bypaths, not the highway.” Jeremiah starts to write his prophecy in turbulent times (around 628BCE), although the Assyrian conquest of Northern Israel had ended, a new threat was emerging on Israel's borders, this time from Babylon. The kings of Israel thought that because God dwelled in the temple in Jerusalem, they would be ok, they neglected their worship and began to believe in false gods. The point that Jeremiah is trying to make is that faith is about more than just ritual worship, it is a relationship with God that should influence every part of our lives. When Jesus says to his disciples in John 14:6 “I am the way and the truth and the life,” he echoes something of this prophecy.

But what does this have to do with walking and companionship? Let us start with companionship. Psychologists believe that the way we perceive ourselves (our self-concept) is developed through our experiences, relationships, culture, and feedback from

others. People with a healthy perception of themselves have often experienced unconditional love from parents and have received encouragement from other important people in their lives. People who have not had such positive experiences often feel like they are not the person they would like to be and do not feel valued. So, it is important to choose our companions wisely.

Some of you reading this will have taken part in the Kington Spring Walking Festival and may even have undertaken one of the pilgrimages. The TV presenter Simon Reeve recently described pilgrimage as a journey of self-discovery. I would argue that true pilgrimage is a journey about discovering ourselves as God sees us. The process of walking, reflecting, and praying helps to recognise that in God's eyes we are all loved and valued equally. This love is unconditional. Longer pilgrimages also help us to identify the things which we might unwisely rely on (coffee, alcohol, sugar, sex etc).

In our digital age there are many ways to distract ourselves from the chaos beyond our borders and difficulties closer to home. However, we are still social beings and only really learn about ourselves by journeying through life with others (and God). If you are able, please consider joining us for one of the smaller Benefice pilgrimages which will run over the next few months. More details on the parish website.

Phillipa



From the Bishop of Hereford

May is a month of transition. At the beginning, we can feel like we're still in winter, with frosts and rain.

By the end, summer feels just around the corner with longer evenings and warmer days. Our lives are still governed by these rhythms even though many of us no longer have the farming

connections we once did. Our ancestors were much more bound by the clock and the seasons. The calendar and liturgical years were intertwined; the church was

more central to people's lives.

Ecclesiastes contains that well known passage about times and seasons, a time to plant and a time to harvest; a time to mourn and a time to laugh; a time to embrace and a time to refrain from embracing. This year, our diocesan family is focusing firmly on celebration. I have always thought that the continued existence of the church is one of the surest proofs of the resurrection. How could an organisation composed of frail, sinful people like you and me still be here but for divine intervention? No other human organisation has continued in this way. The world was vastly different 1350 years ago when Putta made the gruelling journey here from Rochester to become our first Bishop. England didn't exist. Our diocese was carved out of the corner of a Mercian kingdom and part of an old Roman settlement. Over the course of our existence, kings have risen and fallen; cathedrals have been burnt down and rebuilt, fallen and been rebuilt again! Previous Bishops, in a

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All this has happened in the power of the Holy Spirit, whose gift we will celebrate at the end of this month.

variety of acts of architectural vandalism, have used their own (or their wealthy wife's) money to remodel the Palace and even demolish bits of it they didn't like. Meanwhile, in over 400 churches, faithful Christian people have gone about the work of the gospel. Priests have hatched, matched and dispatched, celebrated the sacraments and taught the faith. We have made the transition from Catholic to protestant; from Christendom to being a minority in a largely secular, indifferent and occasionally hostile culture. We have both remained faithful to the tradition and found ways to proclaim the

faith afresh to each generation. There have been times of relative ease and times of real struggle. Churches have fallen down and been rebuilt, and populations have shifted.

All this has happened in the power of the Holy Spirit, whose gift we will celebrate at the end of this month. We have never had to do it on our own, dependent on our own ingenuity. To be a Christian is to be supernaturally empowered by the Holy Spirit. God's faithfulness and that power are definitely worth celebrating.

+ Richard
Bishop of Hereford



St. Mary's Church, Kington

This report is being written in the week after Easter. We do hope that many of you were able to come into church over Easter to admire our various decorations and attend some of the various Easter activities. It will now soon be early summer, and more things taking place.

Wild Church

This takes place in the Vicarage garden on the 2nd Sunday afternoon of the month, 3pm – 4.30pm, with a bonfire and marshmallows amongst other fun things. Do come along on 10th May.

Marches Makers

The church and parish hall are hosting exhibitions during the weekend of the May bank holiday, from Saturday 6th – Monday 8th May. Free entry. There will also be a concert in church on the Saturday evening. Do see the various posters for more information.

Pilgrimages and Concerts

Pilgrimages are taking place from each of the benefice churches monthly beginning on Sunday 17th May and ending in the church for tea. Do come along – each walk is between 3 and 5 miles long.

We are also hosting a series of concerts in church this summer. More details will be available shortly.

Ceiling in church

We are sorry to have to report that another area of plaster has fallen from the ceiling of the church, this time in the Vaughan chapel. It is currently roped off, and hopefully by the time you are reading this, it will have been repaired, but if not, please take care if you go into the chapel.



Beetle Drives

As usual, in the parish hall at 7pm on the 2nd Tuesday of the month. Great fun do come and join us on 12th May.

We are having our Annual Parochial Church Meeting in a few days time, so when you read this a second churchwarden will have been appointed, and Ann will be enjoying a well-earned retirement after 25 years.

With very best wishes to you all,

*Ann Edwards and Margaret Cooke,
churchwardens.*



– Kington Creations –

St Mary's Lego Club

Thousands of bricks, Lots of mini figures,
Loads of fun !

Wednesday 20th May

3:30pm – 5:00pm

St Marys Church Kington

Young children to be accompanied
by an adult please

Refreshments available

legoclub.kington@gmail.com

Having fun creating together

Ann Edwards: a name synonymous with commitment and dedication – the personification of piety and devotion.

Twenty-five years ago, Ann replaced me as Churchwarden of St Mary's where I had been in the post for a mere thirteen years.

Ann always showed respect, kindness and warmth – resulting in a true Christian welcome as one entered the church. Her distinct and modest presence, which was hugely appreciated, gave stability and quiet authority; she seemed to be always in attendance.

Just a 'Thank you' may seem inadequate, but it is given with sincerity: it is so well deserved. God bless you Ann.

Allan Lloyd



After 25 years of loyal and dedicated service to St Mary's Church, Ann Edwards has stepped down as churchwarden.

Ann was born in Kington, baptised and confirmed at St Mary's and after teaching in Birmingham and Edgbaston returned to Kington to become a greatly valued and loved member of the church. At the Annual Parochial Church Meeting on April 12th Ann was presented with flowers and a personal letter of thanks from the Bishop of Hereford.

Operation Dove

During the last four weeks, most of the activity for the Dove has been concerned with the planning application to convert the property from a pub to a community space. This has involved several meetings with the builder and electrician to decide the best way forward. The large wooden bar has now been removed, and this has revealed quite a lot of rotten floorboards, presumably due to beer spillage. However, this also revealed a large number of lost coins which amounted to nearly £20 so we've put it in the Lifeboat collection box which had been left in the bar. This will be donated in due course.

There has been quite a lot of progress in the Yarn Barn attached to the Dove, with the walls and ceiling being repaired and painted, and it is all beginning to look a great deal better. One of the biggest steps forward has been the removal of a large cold store in the corner of the room, and this has revealed a door out into Harp Yard. This had been blocked up and rendered on the outside so was a complete surprise. We are not going to reinstate this doorway but will use the area for a bookcase where we can display craft books either for reference or for sale.

We are hoping that the Yarn Barn and Courtyard will be ready for our first activities by early to mid-May, and we will be holding craft demonstrations and "have a go" sessions to start with followed by various courses on weaving, spinning, knitting and crochet. We've got all the equipment that we need and are really looking forward to starting. The Dove will inevitably be a few months later in being open for business, but once the planning permission has been obtained, progress should be quite swift. We will be keeping you informed of how it is progressing in both the Parish News and on Kington Chat. If you have any activities you'd like to see included, please get in touch.

Freda and Alison felandamh298@gmail.com

St Mary's Barnabas Breakfast



Thursday 14th May 9:30 in the Parish Hall

Come and join us for an egg & bacon breakfast in support of Barnabas Aid

New!

Stay and Play

Baby & Toddler Group

For parents and carers with children aged 0-3, no booking required.

St Mary's Parish Hall

(parking at rear)

Tuesdays 9:15-10:45

Term Time Only



Light refreshments, stories and songs, lots of toys, themed activities.

Group provided by St Mary's Kington PCC. Suggested donation £2

Barnabas Aid is an international aid agency that aims to support Christian communities, churches and individuals around the world who face persecution and discrimination because of their faith.

Bring Hope – One Plate At A Time

A Barnabas Brekkie is a way for you to support the work of Barnabas Aid.

Eat bacon and eggs. Give pigs and chickens.

Barnabas Aid have set a target of providing one million pigs and one million chickens to Christian farmers in contexts of marginalisation and poverty. A simple meal of bacon and eggs can be used to promote this project.

Chickens are cheap and versatile animals. Their meat is a healthy source of protein, and their eggs are a nutritious food source that can also provide the basis for a small business.

Pig meat is valuable, and their manure can be used in agriculture. In areas where Christian farmers are attacked by Islamist bandits, pigs will not be stolen as they are considered unclean in Islam.

Barnabas Aid is an international aid agency that aims to support Christian communities, churches and individuals around the world who face persecution and discrimination because of their faith.

Church Cake Stall

We will be having a **Cakes & Bakes** stall at **Hergest Croft Spring Fair** on the **Spring Bank Holiday Monday 4 May** in aid of St Mary's church funds, so if you are going to the fair, please look out for us and hopefully buy some of our goodies. We'll also be selling homemade Marmalade, Jelly and Chutney as well as some Fudge, so there will be a big choice - particularly if you come early!

Freda & Alison

St Thomas a Becket, Huntington

APC + PCC Meetings:

Our APC and PCC Meetings were held in church on Wednesday 8th April, where, amongst other matters, the Trustees' Annual Report & Accounts was approved.

Fortunately, Huntington finances continue to stay "in the Black" mainly due to people who donate generously to the Parish Giving Scheme, which amounts to approximately 50% of our income. Income is also generated from the popular church merchandise table, where an assortment of jams/chutneys (thanks to Fiona, Honor, Marilyn and Pauline), mats, cards, iSpy Quiz sheets, etc., can be purchased. Essential income is also derived from our share of proceeds from Kington Community Shop and Huntington Annual Village Fete and from the occasional Talks (Father & Son Brunel being the last one held). It is essential our funds remain healthy to ensure our village church remains functional and is there for weddings (2 currently scheduled for 2026), baptisms and funerals and for the

parishioners who attend services. As is the case in most churches, parishioner numbers are dwindling, although the Sung Evensong, held on the fourth Sunday of each month, is proving to be extremely successful.

Huntington church will continue to play an important role in the Pilgrim Walks Project, which has proved to be very successful. All the walks from 2025 are available to download for free from the Benefice website and QR code posters in each church. The first guided walk for 2026 is around the whole benefice in 3 days, as part of the Kington Walking Festival. Later in the summer there will be a new walk from each church with tea afterwards, details to follow nearer the time.

The St. Lazarus Group continue to hold their Annual Carol Service in Huntington church, with members travelling miles to attend, as they hold this church very dear in their hearts.

Church Maintenance:

Church maintenance is continually ongoing. Currently work is in progress to repair the damaged interior plaster panels, which should be completed shortly. Flooding in the

St. Peter's Church Titley

Readers

Sunday 3rd May Elizabeth

Sunday 17th May David

Flowers

Flowers for May Jill

Easter Service

We had a good number for our Easter Day Service, and this was led by Rev. Rosie Roberts who took a very special service with a very thought-provoking sermon which was enjoyed by all. Special thanks to all the ladies who decorated the church to make it look so colourful.

The Great Titley Potato Challenge

If you have not yet got your seed potato and bucket to grow your prizewinning crop of potatoes for the Village Fete, please give Amelda George a ring and she can let you have one (07584420288) This is very competitive but also great fun.

Best Wishes

We send all our prayers and best wishes for a speedy recovery to John Turner who has spent some considerable time in hospital.

cellar is an ongoing problem, which needs to be resolved. The rotten barge boards to the East end elevation have now been replaced, which was undertaken during the winter, so as not to upset the wild bees who have been in residence for many years. This has now stopped the squirrels from gaining entry into the roof space, but unfortunately the woodpeckers are back trying to get to the bees, so we need to try some deterrents. If you have any ideas – please contact Fiona Shone. The bees are thriving and were totally unaffected by the work.

The Quinquennial Report highlighted other areas requiring attention and Peter Kelly (Churchwarden) is making progress with ensuring remedial work is undertaken in these areas.

It is amazing how many people visit Huntington church throughout the year, either on walks, finding the GeoCash location/treasure, or just tourists visiting the area. There are some lovely heartfelt comments in the Visitor Book, as our small village church seems to make a real impression.

Susan Maiden

Lent Lunch

Many thanks to everyone who made the soup and helped out at the recent Lent Lunch. Thanks go to everyone who came and supported the lunch, and special thanks go to everyone from outside Titley parish who supported the lunch so well. With some of the money from the Christmas lunch, and the proceeds from the lunch we sent the excellent sum of £385 to St Michaels Hospice.

Many thanks
Dick

St Thomas a Becket Church, Huntington looks for a new treasurer

Our current treasurer, Will Shone, will be resigning at the end of June and a vacancy will arise.

We appeal to anyone in the Benefice who would like to fill the position.

We have a small but regular congregation with services twice a month. Currently, our annual expenditure is met out of annual revenue. The church and churchyard are maintained by the wardens. Worshipers, visitors and those wishing to be baptised, married or buried can be sure that the church is there for all as and when needed alongside our regular services twice a month.

There are two wardens and a secretary, but a treasurer is needed to look after the day-to-day finances.

If you are interested, please contact Peter Kelly or Will.

peterbkelly642@hotmail.com 01544370266
shone.will@gmail.com 07767786594

At the recent AGM for Titley Village Hall, we are pleased to say that, as a result of a very successful Community Christmas lunch and other events during the year, we have been able to donate

£250.00 to We Are Farming Minds and £250.00 to Borderlands Rural Chaplaincy. Two charities which are local to our area.

The Hall continues to be busy with a wide range of organisations using the facilities and has enjoyed another successful year.

Judith Jones
Secretary

Wild Church

Sunday 10th May, 3pm

Vicarage Garden, Church Street,
Kington HR5 3AG

Wild Church is an informal gathering where families and individuals can join in with nature-based activities. Sessions led by local Forest School Association Instructor.

Hot drinks around the fire with toasted marshmallows!

All are Welcome

Bring Wellies and Waterproofs if possible

Kington Parishes: May 2026

Sunday, 3rd 5th Sunday of Easter

Acts 7:55-end, Psalm 31: 1-5, 15-16, 1 Peter 2 :2-10, John 14: 1-14

8.30am:	Holy Communion:	Titley
10.00am:	Holy Communion:	Kington *
4.00pm:	Lambing Service:	Old Radnor
6.00pm	Praise and Prayer Evening	Kington

Sunday, 10th 6th Sunday of Easter

Acts 17: 22-31, Psalm 66:7-end, 1 Peter 3: 13-end, John 14:15-21

8.30am:	Holy Communion:	Huntington
10.00am:	Holy Communion:	Kington *
11.30am:	Holy Communion:	Old Radnor
3.00pm	Wild Church	Kington

Thursday 29th Ascension Day.

Acts 11: 1-11, Psalm 47, Luke 24:44-end

8.30am	Holy Communion, followed by breakfast	Kington
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Sunday, 17th 7th Sunday of Easter

Acts 1:6-14, Psalm 68: 1-10, 1 Peter 4: 12-14, John 17:1-11

10.00am:	Holy Communion:	Titley
11.00am:	Picnic Praise:	Kington
6.00pm:	Evening Prayer	Old Radnor

Sunday, 25th Pentecost

Acts 2: 1-21, Psalm 104: 26-36, 37b, 1 Corinthians 12:3b-13, John 20:1-9?

10.00am:	Holy Communion:	Kington *
6.00pm	Sung Evensong:	Huntington

Sunday, 31st Trinity Sunday

Isaiah 40:12-17,27-end, Psalm 8, 2 Corinthians 13:11-end, Matthew 28:16-end

10.00am	Group Communion	Kinnerton
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* Live-streamed services

WEEK DAY SERVICES

Morning Prayer takes place at 9am in Kington every Monday, Wednesday and Friday, and Evening Prayer at 4pm on Mondays. All welcome

At the Annual Church Meeting held on 12 April 2026, it was unanimously approved that St Mary's Kinnerton should become a Festival Church. A Festival Church is a church building which is not used for weekly worship, but is valued and required by the community for local events and for Festivals of the Church and for Rites of Passage (Baptisms, Weddings, Funerals. There will be fewer services held, but these will include Harvest, Crib, Christmas Day and Easter as well as 31 May and 30 August 2026. It is hoped that the community will continue to support St Mary's as it has done so well in the past.

Sally Welch, Vicar

Ruth Lewis Jones, Susan Thompson, Churchwardens

5 God by Numbers

The Philistines, in their battle lines, sent the giant Goliath daily to taunt the Israelites. With helmet of bronze, coat of chain mail and mighty javelin, he towered over them, sneering at their God. Saul sent the shepherd boy David to challenge Goliath. Forsaking heavy armour and all convention he selected **5** smooth pebbles from the stream; then, sling in hand, he approached the giant. With the authority of God's kingdom David said to him, "You come to me with sword and spear, but I come to you in the name of the Lord of hosts whom you have defied." Selecting a stone he quickly closed on the Philistine and slung it, striking him on the forehead. Taking the fallen giant's sword he cut off his head.

God honoured David for his courage and faith; it's worth noting that God also made use of David's skills, including the selection of pebbles. Why five?! Jesus fed the **5** thousand on a Galilean hillside, making use of what his disciples had. When asked for food, all they could find him were **5** loaves and 2 small fish. Looking up Jesus blessed the bread and gave it to them; they in turn gave it to the people. When all had eaten their fill, the disciples collected the scraps gathering 12 baskets. Our God is a God of abundance. He also values us. "Are not **5** sparrows sold for 2 pennies? And not one of them is forgotten before God."

Robert MacCurrach and David Stearns

Kington Art and Craft Market

Firstly, thank you to all those who visited the Art and Craft Market on Sat 18th April.

Saturday 16th May 9:30 a.m. – 3.00p.m.

Kington Market Hall and Place de Marines.

In May we have several new crafters joining us plus our regulars.

Kington Art & Craft Market offers a wide variety of unique items from different local Artists and Crafters. We have something for everyone. Our stalls offer sewn, crochet & knitted items; papercraft and cards; pottery, basketry felted items, jewellery, honey and vintage tools to name but a few. So please put the date in your diary, pop along to see us and support local artists and crafters in their work.

We look forward to seeing you on May 16th.

A Good Friday Reflection

On the Friday of Holy week. Trish and Rob MacCurrach led a very moving reflection based on the final hours of Jesus' life; endeavouring to understand the pain, humiliation, loneliness and power of the cross, with readings from John's gospel, meditation, music and prayer.

Some of the elements of that final hour were presented to us in the form of material objects.

We held the long hard nails and imagined the pain and suffering as Jesus was nailed to the cross.

We felt the long vicious thorns that would have been used to construct the crown upon his head as he was humiliated and mocked,

The stones, marked with the sign of the cross, our reminder of the heavy weight of suffering our Lord endured.

Finally- the bulb, with the promise of new life.

In between the reflections on the sufferings inflicted on Jesus from the nails, thorns and stones, we sang hymns and Taizé chants, meditated and prayed.

During the silences the church became darker, and the force of the wind became more apparent. It rattled the heavy oak doors, roaring round the ancient church- becoming fiercer still- as though Jesus was hammering at the door, or possibly God himself, angry with the world.' This is my beloved son, CRUCIFIED FOR YOU. What else must I do?'

Everyone witnessed and marvelled at the strength of the wind. Reminiscent of that first Good Friday

The hour finished with a beautiful poem, written by Beth Roberts and read by Trish. A poem that affirmed God's love for us, whatever trials life may have in store.



There was no church service on Saturday, but on Easter Day the church was full. The sun streamed through the stained-glass windows, lighting up the beautiful flowers. The singing from the choir and congregation was joyful. The wind was at peace.

Jesus is Risen, Alleluia!!!

Deborah Sell

KINGTON COMMUNITY LUNCH CLUB

Come and enjoy a 2-course meal in a friendly environment with other local seniors at:

Kington Parish Hall

(HR5 3AG)

at 12:30 p.m.

Cost is £6

We meet on the
3rd Wedne

sday of each month.

Next lunch is on 20th May

Contact: Sarah 01544 598125

Reader Writes

An old friend, once a soldier, told me a story I won't forget. On attachment to a Gulf state, they were leading operations in a long running regional insurgency. An ambush had been set and the "adu" duly cautiously advanced up the wadi and into the ambush. Just as my friend was about to order "fire!", his interpreter lying hidden beside him stood up. The adu of course disappeared in a blink.

Wrestling with the impulse to strangle his interpreter he asked What the hell did you do that for? "He was my brotherwhat could I do?" Indeed. The conclusion? War is usually the worst option, and it frequently fails.

In the Gaza war and in this latest Israeli/US war on Iran, the Chinese general Sun Tzu 500BC offers relevant wisdom: "Tactics without strategy is the noise before defeat." Yes, it's eerily relevant yet again to the present conflict. Commentators, universally, have struggled to see the strategic goals that an aerial campaign will achieve. The US can destroy military and energy infrastructure, but without a massive commitment to forces on the ground, San Tzu would call it the noise before strategic defeat.

Iran is a vast country the size of Western Europe with a population heading for 100 million; travelling there long ago I was left with a deep impression of a vibrant people. Most of us long for liberation for the younger educated population, and especially for the persecuted church. Living in north Herefordshire I have Quaker friends whose principled opposition to armed conflict makes it even harder to justify war over patient negotiation. Earning the hatred

of a generation and more of Iranians or Palestinians is not a desirable or helpful strategic outcome.

Coming back to my old soldier friend, war is rarely the best option. But whether Hitler's Reich or today's war in the Middle East, the generals who might help stop it appear to be silent. We all know it's complicated, and sometimes seemingly impossible. Is there a Christian view where criticism is thought to be acceptable? Should we, can we, speak

truth to power? There is certainly a long bible tradition of prophetic opposition to power. Famously King David committed adultery with Bathsheba, and then had her husband murdered on the battlefield and took her to be his own. The (fearless) prophet Nathan confronted the king by way of allegory. A rich man took a poor man's lamb, rather than one of his own, for a sacrifice. King David was furious, calling for the disgraceful rich man to be arrested. "You are that man"

said the prophet.

The bible record of the prophetic speaking of truth to power was usually dangerous. In the New Testament John the Baptist ended up in prison with a grizzly end for opposing Herod's unlawful marriage. Jesus was astonishingly forthright in his criticism of the leading Pharisees and scribes, calling them "whitewashed" tombs. It hastened his arrest and handing over for crucifixion. Archbishop Desmond Tutu is a modern example. I would love it to be unnecessary to endanger oneself, but there is much we need to stand up for, from carbon consumption to social justice. Lord, give us wisdom, and give us the courage to follow it.

Robert MacCurrach

I would love it to be unnecessary to endanger oneself, but there is much we need to stand up for, from carbon consumption to social justice. Lord, give us wisdom, and give us the courage to follow it.

MONTHLY MUSINGS

During Easter week my mind was taken over by a song, which has crept into my brain and won't go away.

John Brown's body lies a mouldering in the grave X3

But his soul goes marching on.

Chorus: Glory, glory, hallelujah X3

His soul goes marching on.

And when you think about it, what a wonderful Easter hymn it would make. And see how it backs up what I wrote a couple of months ago when musing about the soul, suggesting it might be all that's left of us when the rest has gone!

John Brown, the hero in this saga was, I understand, a soldier serving during the American Civil War in the 1800's. He was apparently a fanatical and famously militant abolitionist. It was this that got him into serious trouble, and he was hanged, as the last 2 lines of one version of his song says:

They hung him for a traitor; themselves the traitor crew,

But his soul is marching on.

This lyric is taken from a book written and published in Chicago in 1861 by a Rev William W. Patton, which became tremendously popular during the war. It had six verses, each championing John Brown as a martyr after his demise.

Do you believe in god-incidences, I wonder? The two issues which thrust themselves forward for me in "John Brown's Body" are soul and slavery, and, amazingly, at Morning Prayer, this morning, 9th April, the O.T. Lesson, from Exodus, was about the Children of Israel's escape from slavery in Egypt, and the N.T. Lesson from 1 Corinthians 15, is all about (Verse 35ff) the resurrection body: But his soul is marching on!

It was for abolitionism that John Brown was hanged, and it was for having a soul, a

resurrection body, that he was acclaimed! Celebrated as a hero he was, not least by the six verses of Rev. William W. Patton.

By the time this article appears in our Parish News we shall be entering May and celebrating Ascension Day, 14th and Pentecost, 24th before we are buried in the long season of Trinity. Ascension marks the return of Jesus to God the Father, and Pentecost the gift of The Holy Spirit to all who will receive it by being baptised. And the O.T. Lesson often read at Pentecost begins: *A new heart I will give you, and a new spirit I will put within you; and I will take out of your flesh the heart of stone and give you a heart of flesh...* (Ezekiel 36). I believe that that spirit, that new heart, feeds into one's soul, inspiring in it whatsoever is good and of eternal value, to create a soul to go marching on!

Denis Parry.



Exhibitions
Open Studios
Performances
Workshops
Demonstrations

Early May Bank Holiday
2nd-4th May 2026

St Mary's Church – Market Hall – around Kington

marchesmakers.co.uk

Not a Proper Gardener (Part 62)

I'm writing this on Easter Monday. The frost is being defeated by the sun and so my solar panels are happy again continuing to make up for a lazy start this year. And the occasional recent light frost has been compensated for by some seasonal spring weather. Although storms are more common than was usual, we seem to have missed the worst, as was the case with Storm Dave which just clipped us the other night on its way through.

Emma has been busy in the garden whenever she can spare an hour or so. She bought and planted a few new raspberry canes but isn't very sanguine about their enthusiasm to survive. So far only the odd leaf or so. It sounds as if they need a good talking to! The salads have finished in the greenhouse; they were going to seed and ended up in the soup pan. She has replaced them with some of the broad beans from my coir pot windowsill provision. She's also been able to plant out the sweet peas, and there are other plants ready for her when the time's right.

The beautiful white blossom on the three plum and damson trees looks to be the best ever, despite the occasional touches of frost. I think the miserable wet weather we had earlier must have done some good. All the fruit trees look well – but then we did wassail them!



The jungle has received a bit of cursory attention from the mower. The jungle grassland was getting a bit out of hand; but the primroses and celandines were and still are so beautiful, and who knows what wildlife thrives therein? We discovered a sleeping hedgehog on our first trawl, so left that section well alone. Anyway, if we want to see a beautifully maintained lawn, we have only to look out of the window at the football pitch!

And the jungle values its wildlife. Emma's care of the birds and of the hedgehogs, of which at least two have come out of hibernation and are tucking into the calci worms she buys for them, is exemplary. But especially at present it's the tadpoles. About them, she says, "The five lots of spawn outgrew their shallow birdbath, so once the first tadpoles appeared I split them up, putting some in the pond and the rest in a tub. I'm having to cover the tub with an upside-down wheelbarrow during these frosts, and latterly, instead, with some fleece over a cage to prevent the birds from fishing." I'm surprised she didn't take them a hot water bottle to keep them warm!

Happy gardening, Denis.

Kington Parish Hall for Hire!!

Planning an Event?

**Wakes, Birthdays, Anniversaries, Business Meetings
Family Celebrations, Small Group Meetings**

*Contact: Penny Halcrow
p.s.halcrow@gmail.com*

*Fully-equipped kitchen
Ample parking*

OAK | Open Arms Kingston May events

Events and opening at The Oxford Arms, Kingston, May 2026.

Details for all events on our website (openarmskington.co.uk).

Tel: 07301081444, email info@openarmskington.co.uk.



Saturday 2nd-Sunday 3rd May, 11am-5pm both days. *Marches Makers Festival.*

Dance, craft stalls, and displays at The Oxford Arms. Bar and café open. Free

Wednesday 6th May, 10am-12.30pm. *Sunflower Social at Places of Welcome.* A hidden disabilities support group and network, meeting in The Oxford's barn on the first Wednesday of the month during our regular Places Of Welcome opening hours. Free.

Sunday 9th May, 1-5pm. *Herefordshire Histories Festival.* Exhibition and a talk from Richard Wheeler, author of *The Old Words of Herefordshire* (2024). Bar and café open. Free.

Wednesday 13th May, 10am-12.30pm. *Dementia Matters at Places of Welcome.* Support group and network for people affected by dementia, meeting in The Oxford's barn on the second Wednesday of the month during our regular Places Of Welcome opening hours. Free.

Tuesday 19th May, from 6pm. *The Veteran Trees of the Marches.* A talk by Josie Bridges, Welsh Marches Project Officer for Natural Resources Wales. Bar open. Free, but donations encouraged. Unreserved seating, please arrive early to ensure a place.

Friday 29th May, 6-10pm. *Quiz night at The Oxford Arms.* Teams of max 4 people, £3pp entry, cash prize for the winning team. Bar open throughout.

Sunday 31st May, 2-4pm. *Creative Workshop at The Oxford Arms.* This month's activity is papermaking! Payment by donation (suggested £5). Live 100 Club draw at 3pm. Bar open throughout but no café this month.

Regular opening hours in May:

Places of Welcome at The Oxford Arms, every
Wednesday morning in May, 10am-12.30pm

OAK | Open Arms Kingston CiC

www.openarmskington.co.uk

comms@openarmskington.co.uk

May

Please get in touch if your group is within a 10 mile radius of Kingston and would like to be added to a small waiting list who will be offered any vacancies as they arise

Rita Langford

01544 230562

Adrian Wilcox

kingtoncommunityshop@outlook.com

Kingston & District Community Shop

06-May Almeley Primary School

13-May Old Radnor Church

20-May Walnut Gardens

27-May Walton Village Hall

KINGSTON
&
DISTRICT
Community
Shop

News From the Museum

Granny Lloyd of Colva 1853-1935

A remarkable farmer's daughter, who married into the "labouring class", as husband Tom was the local road man in an isolated Welsh border area of Radnorshire. The couple lived in a small cottage on a bare hillside, close to a farm cum pub, a little church with a small congregation and the nearest village 2 miles away, with the market town 8 – 10 miles distance. With no transport available a very tight knit Hamlet, a farming community, with residents depend on each other in times of hardship, sickness and distress.

Granny Lloyd bore 4 boys and 4 girls. This was time of considerable hardship and the inadequacies of the cottage, made Granny to be a very resourceful, prudent wife, supplementing Tom's wages by charring, baby minding, sewing, knitting, and the families annual foraging of Winberry picking on the hills. Tom had a good vegetable garden, with a pig fattening in the cote ready to feed his growing family.

Neighbours in their time of need would call on Granny's with good deal knowledge and common sense give help. No NHS or Social Services help or support for families in those days. Gran was a shy person, not given to much talk, but high on action and deeds with a heart of gold.

How did all these children and parents live in one tiny cottage? Probably a two up and two down. As the older children left home, they made space for the younger ones, or those to come, probably sleeping two or three to a bed, top and tail as they had short legs.

As the children left school at age the age of twelve or thirteen, the girls would go into service in good class homes, often with

families or friends, knowing the children would learn good housekeeping skills. The boys obviously went into farming, with 3 becoming very successful farmers in their own right. The youngest boy tried farming, but deciding it was not for him, going on to become a successful engineer in Yorkshire, having learnt his trade via Swansea, Cardiff and Coventry.

One daughter became a very talented teacher, working her way up to become deputy head of one of the best-known public girl's schools. Two married successful farmers, all children making a good life for themselves. By 1986 Granny's family had grown to number nearly 120.

Very independent, Granny Lloyd lived in her little cottage for the next 16 years after the death of Tom, making few demands for help, secure in the knowledge she only had to ask and it would come.

During her last illness the two unmarried daughters look turns in nursing Granny.

Living to 82 years old, a was much loved and highly respected lady by all who knew her.

Wendy Jones

May 15th 2026

"From County to Command:

Sir Edward Hopton,

A Herefordshire Officer

in the Victorian Age"

given by Emalee Beddoes

at The Burton Hotel

2pm – 3pm.

**Free entry, but donations
welcomed..**



BROUGHT TO YOU BY CUF⁺

St Mary's Kington is starting a Growing Good course led by Rob and Trish MacCurrach. First session **7.00 pm Wed 15 April** in the Parish Hall, next to the vicarage; seventh and final session Wed 27 May.

Growing Good develops the connection between community and church. Together groups will look at scripture, think about our local community, explore their gifts, and find inspiration for putting ideas into action.

All welcome; invite friends. We hope others across the Deanery and Diocese might also come. For more information and login:

<https://growing-good.org.uk/toolkit> To register or for queries, contact rob.maccurrach@gmail.com .



Kington Tourist Information Office has opened to a busy week of visitors over the Easter period. The recently refurbished window displays are holding a display of colourful posters and information that shows visitors to the town what a busy and vibrant town Kington is.

Being a volunteer at the TIC can be a rewarding experience helping visitors to the town explore the area and its many attractions. Could you be somebody who could give just a few hours each month to help us promote our town and its businesses.

It is also good to report that our new web site, visitkington.co.uk is well underway and this will further help to promote the town and all that happens here to the wider public.

If you would like to know more about becoming a volunteer or would like your business featured on visitkington.co.uk then call into the office for a chat or email visitkington@gmail.com.

Caring for God's Acre

Here we go gathering nuts in May...

One of the joys of exploring a churchyard, chapel yard or cemetery can be the small, unobtrusive plants that you may find. Pignut is one of these. This plant has light, feathery leaves, looking like those found on a carrot top and you may find a near carpet of them in an old churchyard in the spring. It flowers in April and May, producing small, white flowers in clusters that are known as umbels. In fact, Pignut is a member of the umbellifer family, the same plant family as the more familiar carrot, cow parsley and fennel, but unlike its relatives, it is small, the leaves low

Pignut has several names referring to the dark brown tubers found on its roots. Ground-nut, Cat-nut, Earth-nut, Earth-chestnut and the less obvious Jog-journals.

obvious Jog-journals. Pignuts were dug up and eaten raw or cooked, when they taste like parsnips.

Pignut is a plant of undisturbed, flowery grassland which is often found within burial grounds as burial grounds, unlike surrounding the surrounding landscape, have seen little change, consistent management and are relatively chemical free. Pignut is also found within woodland, in glades and sunnier spots.

to the ground and the flower on an upright stem of about 30cm.

Pignut has several names referring to the dark brown tubers found on its roots. Ground-nut, Cat-nut, Earth-nut, Earth-chestnut and the less



Again, burial grounds suit it well, having a mosaic light and shade creating different habitats.

So what of the nursery rhyme, Here we go gathering nuts in May, on a cold and frosty morning? Pignut leaves wither and disappear in late spring and, although the flowering stem with seedheads remains visible, the lack of leaves make Pignut plants hard to spot. The time of year to gather them is May, as opposed to other kinds of nut which are harvested in autumn. Another interpretation of the nursery rhyme is that it is a corruption of Here we go gathering knots of May, May being another name for Hawthorn. A knot is an old name for a bunch of flowers and Hawthorn flowers in April when frosts are more likely to occur so that makes sense of the cold and frosty morning.

We would love to know which churchyards, chapel yards and cemeteries contain pignut, in part because this unobtrusive little plant is indicative of species-rich grassland, a habitat which has declined by a staggering 97% since the 1930s. Please take a photograph using the iNaturalist app if you are a smart phone user. If not, use a field guide to check the identification, then send us an email.

All the best,

Harriet Carty

Diocesan Churchyard Environmental Advisor

KINGTON TOWN COUNCIL UPDATE



Things never seem to stand still with the council at the moment. Whilst all appears calm on the surface beneath, we have been paddling furiously dealing with changes and ongoing projects.



Firstly, it has been a pleasure to welcome Rae Morgan to the council. Rae is a local man who brings enthusiasm and knowledge of the town

to the council, and we are sure will help us move forward with our ongoing works,

Secondly, we welcome our new Town Clerk, Michael Greenfield. Michael brings a wealth of knowledge and experience to the role and who is looking forward to getting to know the town and its residents. If you see him around, please stop and say hello and welcome him to Kington.

Now. As many of you are aware the public toilets in town have been a constant source of complaints and concern but being owned and managed by Herefordshire council, it has been difficult to arrange for improvements and repair. However, the Town Council is now negotiating the possible take-over of the management and running of these so that we can be in control and hopefully make them much more presentable and pleasant to use.

As a town we want our visitors and residents to be proud of the facilities we offer and by taking on the one thing that has always caused concern we are showing our commitment to move forward.

Cllr. Martin Woolford. Deputy Mayor

Easy Sudoku

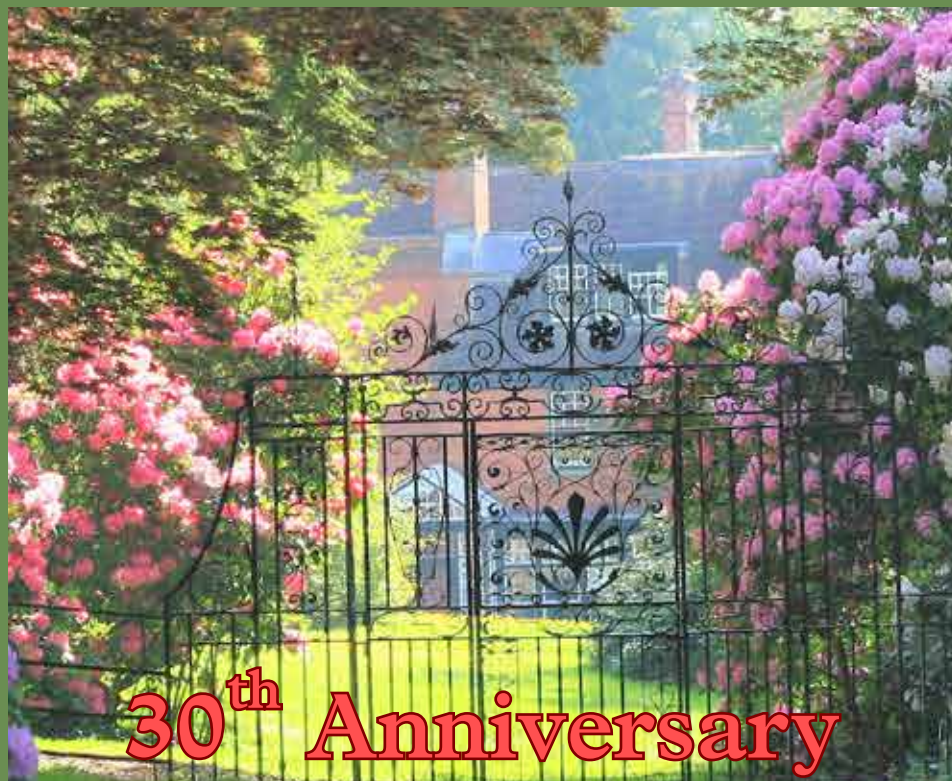
8			6	5			4	
				7	4	3	2	
	3		8		9		1	5
	4			1		2		
2		7				1		9
		8		6			7	
4	7		2		1		6	
	8	6	4	3				
	9			8	6			1

Intermediate Sudoku

8				4				5
5		7			8		6	
	4			5			2	
					9	3		2
9				1				7
4		1	7					
	8			9			7	
	7		2			5		6
1				7				9

Please see page 23 for answers

HERGEST CROFT GARDENS



30th Anniversary

SPRING PLANT FAIR

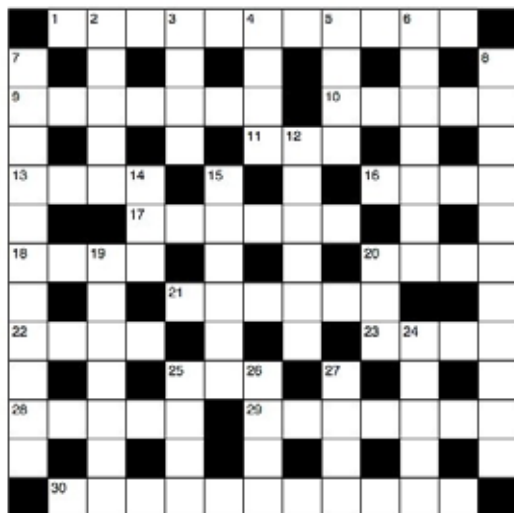
Over 65 exhibitors including rare and unusual trees, shrubs
plants, artisan foods, crafts and much much more!

Monday 4th May

10am - 4pm

WWW.HERGEST.CO.UK

May Crossword



Across

- 1 Overpowered (Deuteronomy 11:4) (11)
- 9 'The — are mantled with corn' (Psalm 65:13) (7)
- 10 'Each man—a sword to his side' (Exodus 32:27) (5)
- 11 On the death of Jesus the curtain in the temple was torn from— to bottom (Matthew 27:51) (3)
- 13 Stagger (Isaiah 28:7) (4)
- 16 'Anyone, then, who knows the good he ought—and doesn't do it, sins' (James 4:17) (2,2)
- 17 Stir up or provoke (Acts 13:50) (6)
- 18 Burden (Luke 11:46) (4)
- 20 'As far as the east is from the—, so far has he removed our transgressions from us' (Psalm 103:12) (4)
- 21 Sign (Luke 23:38) (6)
- 22 'After that, Jesus poured water into a basin and began to—his disciples' feet' (John 13:5) (4)
- 23 The nature of the seven ears of corn which swallowed up the good ears in Pharaoh's dream (Genesis 41:23) (4)
- 25 Has (anag.) (3)
- 28 'This is the account of Shem, Ham and Japheth, —sons' (Genesis 10:1) (5)
- 29 'I will...make them drunk, so that they...sleep for—and— awake' (Jeremiah 51:39) (4,3)
- 30 Paul said of him, 'he often refreshes me and is not ashamed of my chains' (2 Timothy 1:16) (11)

Down

- 2 Worth (Matthew 13:46) (5)
- 3 'A bruised — He will not break' (Matthew 12:20) (4)
- 4 'Suddenly a great company of the heavenly — appeared with the angel' (Luke 2:13) (4)
- 5 Slip (anag.) (4)
- 6 'Take an awl and push it through his — into the door, and he will become your servant for life' (Deuteronomy 15:17) (3,4)
- 7 Bountiful (2 Corinthians 8:2) (11)
- 8 'Therefore, as we have —, let us do good to all people' (Galatians 6:10) (11)
- 12 Acquire (2 Timothy 2:10) (6)
- 14 Container cover (Numbers 19:15) (3)
- 15 'He...became obedient to death, even death on—!' (Philippians 2:8) (1,5)
- 19 Refrain (1 Peter 2:11) (7)
- 20 'She began to—his feet with her tears' (Luke 7:38) (3)
- 24 One who worships Brahma, Vishnu or Shiva (5)
- 25 'Give to everyone who—you' (Luke 6:30) (4)
- 26 'I lift up my eyes to the hills; where does my—come from?' (Psalm 121:1) (4)
- 27 One of those whom the Lord said would be taken from Jerusalem and Judah as judgment on them (Isaiah 3:2) (4)

Please see page 23 for answers

From Lady Hawkins School

This month, we're proud to showcase the imagination and talent of one of our Year 10 students. Focusing on a simple bus journey, Gee Williams uses vivid description to capture the atmosphere, movement, and changing surroundings along the way. It's a reminder that even the most ordinary moments can become engaging when observed closely and expressed creatively.

We hope you enjoy this piece and join us in celebrating Gee's creativity.

Miss Moss

**The river
trickled under
the viaduct that
they travelled
on, with peach
and salmon
stones towering
and arching like
a lotus flower.**

The darkness swallowed the train as cries started to haunt the tunnel. The steep auburn arch made from the local red bricks had been cloaked in mist and the ebony stillness swept through the carriage with vigour upon entering the tunnel. No-one dared to move. No-one dared to breathe. The train chugged softly, whistling into the ears of those tucked safely inside. A calming rush of the serene silence flicked from carriage to carriage, and person to person. The train began to glide, and its shuddering wheels emitted steam as the water evaporated. All of a sudden, the tunnel awoke from its slumber.

The breeze sang a chorus of joy and ecstasy! The sun shone brighter than any human lamp. The river trickled under the viaduct that they travelled on, with peach and salmon stones towering and arching like a lotus flower. Across the gorge, a deer leapt gleefully, with a golden spot of fur that gleamed in the sun. A leaf fell patiently through the forget-me-not sky and bristled past the swish of the metallic train. A rabbit found her comfort and a smile grew past her ears. The spiralling bark of a wrinkling red sycamore strode up past the canopy of leaves. Though a deep and royal purple lay underneath as, from far below, the dripping leaves were burgundy. The coarse weather had burnt the foliage orange, with some branches bare, and some evergreen and the bees hummed the forest to sleep.

The sinking sun cast shadows upon the swaying grass. All of the animals looked up at the sky. Above stretched a mass of violet and plum. Below it became maroon and rouge. An amber glowed faintly along the horizon, making mountains appear adventurous and unique. The golden sun shared its infinite glory, showering bushes and shrubs alike. It filtered through a hazel brown iris and shaded it the colour of carnations. The sunset sparkled, gleamed and glowed. It blessed the eyes with heaven and more!

Gee Williams

Answers Page

Easy Sudoku

8	2	1	6	5	3	9	4	7
6	5	9	1	7	4	3	2	8
7	3	4	8	2	9	6	1	5
5	4	3	9	1	7	2	8	6
2	6	7	5	4	8	1	3	9
9	1	8	3	6	2	5	7	4
4	7	5	2	9	1	8	6	3
1	8	6	4	3	5	7	9	2
3	9	2	7	8	6	4	5	1

Crossword

	O	V	E	R	W	H	E	L	M	E	D	
O		A		E		O		I		A		O
V	A	L	L	E	Y	S		S	T	R	A	P
E		U		D		T	O	P		L		P
R	E	E	L		A		B		T	O	D	O
F				I	N	C	I	T	E		B	R
L	O	A	D		R		A		W	E	S	T
O		B			N	O	T	I	C	E		U
W	A	S	H		S		N		T	H	I	N
I		T		A	S	H		H		I		I
N	O	A	H	S			E	V	E	R	N	O
G		I		K			L		R		D	Y
	O	N	E	S	I	P	H	O	R	U	S	

Intermediate Sudoku

8	9	2	1	4	6	7	3	5
5	1	7	3	2	8	9	6	4
6	4	3	9	5	7	8	2	1
7	5	8	4	6	9	3	1	2
9	3	6	8	1	2	4	5	7
4	2	1	7	3	5	6	9	8
2	8	5	6	9	4	1	7	3
3	7	9	2	8	1	5	4	6
1	6	4	5	7	3	2	8	9

**For all
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If you contact the services of anyone advertised here,
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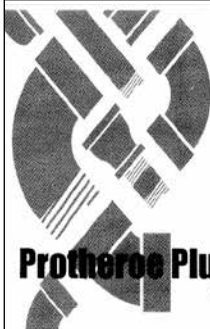
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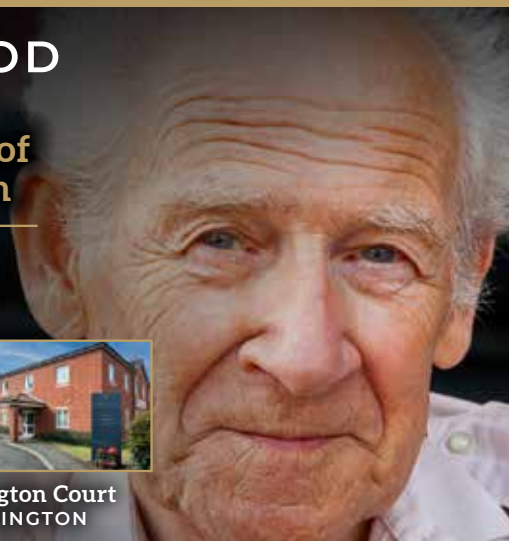
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Kington Mill St

41	41	41	41	41	41
M>F	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa
06:10	08:20	10:10	12:10	15:20	17:30
06:18	08:28	10:19	12:19	15:19	17:39
06:40	-	10:48	12:45	15:55	18:05
	08:53	10:54	12:47	15:57	-

Knighton Bus Station

Knighton Library

36

Knighton Offa's Dyke

Knighton Bus Station

Titiley

Kington Mill St

41	41	41	41	41	41
M>F	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa
06:38	09:07	11:09	13:03	16:13	18:03
06:42	09:11	11:13	13:07	16:17	18:07
07:04	09:35	11:35	13:34	16:39	18:27
07:14	09:45	11:45	13:44	16:49	18:37

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	95	465	465	465	465	465
	T+F	M-F	T-F	M-F	TWF	M-F
Knighton Bus Station	09:10	-	-	09:55	11:20	13:30
Kington Mill St	09:46	11:15	12:30	Leominster Bus Station	-	13:35
Presteigne	-	11:33	12:48	Leominster Morrison's	11:55	14:05
Leominster Morrison's	10:31	-	-	Presteigne	12:13	14:23
Leominster Bus Station	10:36	12:10	13:25	Kington Mill St	10:48	14:23
				Knighton Bus Station	-	14:57

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Forthcoming events

<i>May</i>	<i>Time</i>	<i>Event</i>	<i>Venue & Contact</i>
Thurs 30 th Apr	1pm–3pm	Healthy Lifestyle Group (for 6 weeks)	Parish Hall
Sat 2 nd – Mon 4 th		Made in the Marches Exhibition	St Mary's Church and Hall
Sat 2 nd	7.00pm	Oboe, Clarinet and Piano Recital	St Mary's Church
Sun 3 rd	6.00pm	Prayer and Praise Evening	St Mary's
Mon 4 th	10am–4pm	Cake & Bake Stall in aid of church funds	Hergest Croft Spring Fair
Mon 4 th	12.15–1.30pm	Kington Zero Waste	Parish Hall
<i>Repeated weekly</i>			
Tues 5 th	9.15–10.45	Stay & Play Babies and Toddlers	Parish Hall
<i>Repeated weekly during school term only</i>			
Tues 5 th	7.00pm	St Mary's PCC	Parish Hall
Wed 6 th	7.00pm	Growing Good Course	Parish Hall
		Continuing May 13 th 20 th 27 th	
Fri 9 th	10.00–11.30am	Kington Zero Waste	Parish Hall
<i>Repeated weekly</i>			
Sun 10 th	3.00 – 4.30pm	Wild Church	Kington Vicarage Garden
Tues 12 th	7.00pm	Beetle Drive	Parish Hall
Thurs 14 th	8.30am	ASCENSION DAY communion and breakfast	St Mary's Church
Sun 17 th	11.00am	Picnic Praise	Kington Vicarage Garden
Wed 20 th	3.30pm	Lego Club	St Mary's, Kington
Thurs 21 st	7.00pm	Annual Town Meeting	Burton Hotel
Sun 24 th	6.00pm	Choral Evensong (rehearsal at 5.00 pm)	Huntington Church

FOR DETAILS OF CHURCH SERVICES PLEASE SEE KINGTON PARISHES PAGE 7

Plus plenty of Kington community events at The Oxford Arms, The Old Picture House, Kington Community Choir (Thursdays at The Burton).

You can also find details of many cultural events and activities in Broad Sheep: www.broadsheep.com

If you would like a community event publicised in the Diary please contact: Rev.Paul.C.Roberts@gmail.com

If you or a loved one are unable to make the services at St Mary's but would appreciate prayers or Communion by extension at home, please contact Phillippa (the Curate).

MATERIAL FOR THE June 2026 PARISH NEWS

by **10th May 2026**

Please send by email (maximum 500 words) to:

pn.kingtonparishes@gmail.com

Note: The cut-off date is always the 10th of the previous month